

# INVENTIONS AND INNOVATIONS

## 2026 & 2027 OFFICIAL RATING FORM

### MIDDLE SCHOOL

Judges: Using minimal (1-4 points), adequate (5-8 points), or exemplary (9-10 points) performance levels as a guideline in the rating form, record the scores earned for the event criteria in the column spaces to the right. The X1 or X2 notation in the criteria column is a multiplier factor for determining the points earned. (Example: an "adequate" score of 7 for an X1 criterion = 7 points; an "adequate" score of 7 for an X2 criterion = 14 points.) A score of zero (0) is acceptable if the minimal performance for any criterion is not met.

#### Go/No Go Specifications

- Before judging the entry, ensure that the items below are present; indicate presence with a check mark in the box.
- If an item is missing, leave the box next to the item blank and place a check mark in the box labeled ENTRY NOT EVALUATED.
- If a check mark is placed in the ENTRY NOT EVALUATED box, the entry is not to be judged.

- ☐ TIER 1 – Display is present
- ☐ TIER 2 – Model/prototype is present
- ☐ ENTRY NOT EVALUATED

| TIER 1 – STATIC DISPLAY (60 points)                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Record scores<br>in the column<br>spaces below. |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| CRITERIA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Minimal performance                                                                                                                                                                            | Adequate performance                                                                                                                                              | Exemplary performance                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                 |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 1-4 points                                                                                                                                                                                     | 5-8 points                                                                                                                                                        | 9-10 points                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                 |
| <b>Display</b><br>(X2)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Display is not complete; the information is irrelevant to the invention/innovation, and the display is lacking in aesthetic quality.                                                           | Display includes most components; the idea featured is adequately described; the quality is aesthetically pleasing.                                               | Display is complete; information presented promotes the invention/innovation exceptionally well, and the quality is aesthetically pleasing; the display incorporates the required interactive components. |                                                 |
| <b>Need and Description</b><br>(X2)                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Description of need for invention/innovation is provided, but is unclear and unconvincing; there is not enough detail; invention/innovation is not sensible, practical, or rational in nature. | Description of need for invention/innovation is generally convincing, with some detail; invention/innovation is realistic and generally meets the need as defined | Description of need for invention/innovation is fully explained, defined, and detailed precisely; invention/innovation accurately and convincingly meets the need as defined.                             |                                                 |
| <b>Brainstorming Process</b><br>(X1)                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Description of the brainstorming process provides little or no details.                                                                                                                        | Description of the brainstorming process is provided, and includes some detail about the process; includes little detail about recycled materials used.           | There is clear evidence that brainstorming served as a key component of the process; there is detailed descriptions and explanation of recycled materials used in product.                                |                                                 |
| <b>Illustration/ Drawings</b><br>(X1)                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Only one or two illustrations/ drawings of the model/prototype are displayed, with little or no evidence that a model/prototype was well-developed or utilized.                                | Adequate illustrations/drawings of the model/prototype are included and are generally representative of the concept.                                              | High quality illustrations/drawings of the model/prototype are provided and documented completely.                                                                                                        |                                                 |
| <b>TIER 1 – STATIC DISPLAY SUBTOTAL (60 points)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                 |
| Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right.<br><br>Indicate the rule violated: _____ |                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                 |

**TIER 1 – SUBTOTAL (60 points)****TIER 2 – MODEL/PROTOTYPE (60 points)**

| CRITERIA                                             | Minimal performance                                                                                              | Adequate performance                                                                                 | Exemplary performance                                                                         | Record scores<br>in the column<br>spaces below. |
|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
|                                                      | 1-4 points                                                                                                       | 5-8 points                                                                                           | 9-10 points                                                                                   |                                                 |
| <b>Craftsmanship</b><br>(X2)                         | The model/prototype shows minimal craftsmanship in design and creation.                                          | The model/prototype shows adequate craftsmanship in design and creation.                             | The model/prototype shows exceptional craftsmanship in design and creation.                   |                                                 |
| <b>Feasibility</b><br>(X1)                           | The model/prototype is not realistic and does not have the potential to be workable.                             | The model/prototype is mostly realistic, but would need some changes to be fully workable.           | The model/prototype is very realistic and is completely workable in it's current iteration.   |                                                 |
| <b>Recycled Materials</b><br>(X1)                    | Little or no recycled materials are present in the model/prototype.                                              | The implementation of recycled materials in the model/prototype is adequate.                         | The model/prototype shows exceptional use of recycled materials.                              |                                                 |
| <b>Product Overall Marketability</b><br>(X2)         | The model/prototype does not represent a marketable product and would not be of interest to venture capitalists. | The model/prototype is adequately marketable and would be of slight interest to venture capitalists. | The model/prototype is high marketable and would be of great interest to venture capitalists. |                                                 |
| <b>TIER 2 – MODEL/PROTOTYPE SUBTOTAL (60 points)</b> |                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                      |                                                                                               |                                                 |

Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right.

Indicate the rule violated: \_\_\_\_\_

**PRELIMINARY SUBTOTAL (120 points)****SEMIFINAL SALES PITCH PRESENTATION/INTERVIEW (60 points)**

| CRITERIA                    | Minimal performance                                                                                                                               | Adequate performance                                                                                                                       | Exemplary performance                                                                                                                      | Record scores<br>in the column<br>spaces below. |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
|                             | 1-4 points                                                                                                                                        | 5-8 points                                                                                                                                 | 9-10 points                                                                                                                                |                                                 |
| <b>Organization</b><br>(X1) | Participants seem unorganized and unprepared for the presentation; illogical explanation of the need and solution is presented.                   | Participants are generally prepared for the presentation; explanation of the need and solution are communicated and generally organized.   | The presentation is logical, well organized, and easy to follow; the need and solution are communicated in a concise manner.               |                                                 |
| <b>Knowledge</b><br>(X1)    | Participants seem to have little understanding of the concepts in their project; answers to questions may be vague.                               | Participants exhibit a basic understanding of the concepts in their project.                                                               | Participants show clear evidence of a thorough understanding of the concepts in their project.                                             |                                                 |
| <b>Articulation</b><br>(X1) | Communication of the design process is unclear, unorganized, and/or illogical; leadership and/or 21 <sup>st</sup> century skills are not evident. | Communication of the design process is somewhat logical and clear; leadership and/or 21 <sup>st</sup> century skills are somewhat evident. | Communication of the design process is clear, concise, and logical; leadership and/or 21 <sup>st</sup> century skills are clearly evident. |                                                 |

| SEMIFINAL SALES PITCH PRESENTATION/INTERVIEW (60 points) – continued                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Creativity of Presentation</b><br>(X2)                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Presentation lacks imagination, originality, and detail; there is limited use of audio/visual materials.             | Presentation is generally effective, innovative, and convincing; use of audio/video materials provides information about the invention/innovation. | Presentation is inspiring, inventive, resourceful, and completely convincing; use of audio/visual materials is exceptional in providing information about the invention/innovation. |
| <b>Team Participation</b><br>(X1)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | The majority of the delivery is made by one member of the team; the partner(s) are disengaged from the presentation. | Team members are generally engaged in the process, though one member may take on more responsibility than the other(s).                            | Team members are actively involved in the presentation and responses to the interview questions; there is shared responsibility among the team members.                             |
| <b>SEMIFINAL SALES PITCH PRESENTATION/INTERVIEW SUBTOTAL (60 points)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <p>Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right.</p> <p>Indicate the rule violated: _____</p> |                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| TIME DEDUCTIONS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| A five-(5) point deduction will be incurred for any time infraction.                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>SEMIFINAL SUBTOTAL (60 points)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| To arrive at the TOTAL score, add any subtotals and subtract rules violation points, as necessary.                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                    | <b>TOTAL (180 points)</b>                                                                                                                                                           |

Comments:

I certify these results to be true and accurate to the best of my knowledge.

**JUDGE**

Printed name: \_\_\_\_\_ Signature: \_\_\_\_\_